Abdullah Al Zahid

Toronto, ON | (780) 982-3680 | azahid1@ualberta.ca | linkedin.com/in/abdullah-al-zahid

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Talent Acquisition
Advisory
Mott MacDonald, Toronto, ON

Re: Advisory Consultant

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Advisory Consultant position in Toronto. I worked at Mott MacDonald briefly in early 2023, on Ontario Line traffic simulation, before joining Metrolinx in Service Design, and I am now an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto. I would like to come back to consulting, on the advisory side.

The posting asks for options analysis, research, and clear, defensible recommendations for senior decision-makers. At the City I run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, analyze travel and network data including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, and write the briefing notes and presentations that carry the findings to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions. I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, bringing several years of survey data into one validated source the division reports from.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times and reliability before they were taken forward, and presented that evidence to schedulers, operations staff and engineers. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. The posting asks for eight years of advisory or consulting experience; I have about four and a half years in total, most of it in the public sector. I have not prepared business cases, economic analysis or procurement and commercial strategies, and I have not worked on P3 or other alternative delivery models, commercial management or business development. I do not hold a project management or professional designation.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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